Bethany Clements

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EDUCATION

New York University (NYU) — New York, NY
PhD Student (Communicative Sciences and Disorders) — Started Sep 2025

University of California, Santa Barbara (UCSB) — Santa Barbara, CA
(College of Letters & Science Honors Program) — Jun 2024

- B.S., Psychological and Brain Sciences
- B.A., Linguistics (Emphasis in Speech-Language Sciences and Disorders)
- B.A., English

Capstone Undergraduate Thesis: Recognition Memory as a Function of Word Slot and Contrastive Accenting in the Visual World Paradigm

- Examined the effects of prosodic prominence (via contrastive-pitch accenting) on cognitive-attentional resource allocation, language processing, and memory

GRANTS & SCHOLARSHIPS

Grants

- UCSB Undergraduate Research and Creative Activities (URCA) Grant ($500; 2023-2024)

Scholarships

- NSF Graduate Research Fellowship Program (GRFP) Fellow (2026-2029)

PUBLICATIONS & CONFERENCES

Publications

Under Review

- Clements, B. B.[1, 2], Brehm, L. E.[2], Fraundorf, S. H.[3] (2026). What catches the eye: Recognition memory as a function of contrastive-pitch accenting and word position in the visual world paradigm [Manuscript in preparation]. [1] Communicative Sciences and Disorders Dept., New York University; [2] Linguistics Dept., University of California, Santa Barbara; [3] Psychology Dept., University of Pittsburgh.

Conference Experience

Oral Presentations

- Clements, B. B., Brehm, L. E., Fraundorf, S. H. (2025). What catches the eye: Recognition memory as a function of contrastive accenting and sentence position in the visual world paradigm.
  - 38th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing; University of Maryland (2025)
  - 7th Annual California Meeting for Psycholinguistics; University of California, San Diego (2024)
  - Southern California Undergraduate Linguistics Conference; University of California, Los Angeles (2024)
  - Linguistics Undergraduate Research Showcase; University of California, Santa Barbara (2024)
  - Undergraduate Research Colloquium; University of California, Santa Barbara (2024)

Poster Presentations

- Damore, B., Clements, B. B., Kim, L. D., Crane, G., Hernández Bonilla, C., Riley, E., Yao, M., Yoon, S. O. (2026). Did You Actually Hear That Word?: The Influence of Context on Language Prediction and Memory
    - 9th Annual California Meeting for Psycholinguistics; University of California, Santa Barbara (2026)
    - SHARE-CSD Showcase; New York University (2026)
- Clements, B. B., Liu, L., Brehm, L. E., Yoon, S. O. (2026). Memory for Contrastive-Pitch Accenting in Cantonese-English Bilinguals.
    - 9th Annual California Meeting for Psycholinguistics; University of California, Santa Barbara (2026)
    - Psychonomic Society 67th Annual Meeting; San Diego, CA (2026)
- Clements, B. B., Lee, E., Trinh, M., Upadhyay, S., Hendrickson, K., Yoon, S. O. (2026). The Impact of Modality and Cognitive Aging in Bilingual Lexical Access.
    - Center of Health and Rehabilitation Research Showcase; New York University (2026)
    - 39th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing; Massachusetts Institute of Technology (2026)
- Clements, B. B., Brehm, L. E., Fraundorf, S. H. (2024). What catches the eye: The effects of contrastive accenting on recognition memory in the visual world paradigm.
    - Undergraduate Research Colloquium; University of California, Santa Barbara.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Voice-Assistive Technology Use in Healthy and Cognitively-Impaired Older Adults Sep 2026 - Present

NYU; CoMM Lab (Communicative Sciences and Disorders Dept.)

- Will observe use of voice-assisted devices in populations of older adults, tracking particular instances in which participants experience notable benefits or difficulties to be used in training programs and recommendations for technological development

Conversation Memory in Healthy and Cognitively-Impaired Older Multilinguals Aug 2026 - Present

NYU; CoMM Lab (Communicative Sciences and Disorders Dept.)

- Will examine how conversation memory unfolds across languages in a population of older Korean-English bilinguals, with the goal of determining whether language background necessitates more specialized language-sensitive clinical intervention

Scaffolding Conversation Memory in Healthy and Cognitively-Impaired Older Adults Aug 2026 - Present

NYU; CoMM Lab (Communicative Sciences and Disorders Dept.)

- Will introduce an innovative, ecologically-sensitive paradigm which integrates conversational interactions with delayed memory and attentional measures
- Helped to develop an NIH R01 grant application which is currently in review

Aging, Contrastive Prosody, and Memory Mar 2026 - Present

NYU; CoMM Lab (Communicative Sciences and Disorders Dept.)

- Will supervise a CSD MS student in their research thesis project, extending my previous work on contrastive prosody into a population of older adults

Lexical Overlap in Parent-Child Dyads With Autism Jan 2026 - Present

NYU; LEARN Lab (Communicative Sciences and Disorders Dept.)

- Analyzed and coded existing corpus data to observe the frequency, type, and influence of lexical overlap patterns in childhood
- Compiled a literature review on the presence and effect of parent-child lexical overlap in language acquisition for children with autism

Acoustic Predictors of Dementia Onset Dec 2025 - Present

NYU; mLab (Electrical and Computer Engineering Dept.)

- Served as a psycholinguistic consultant for ablation study designs detecting whether acoustic-linguistic biomarkers of ADRD are reflected in network traffic trends
- Collected acoustic conversation data from a software-based system, comparing ADRD detection ability between this data and more traditional linguistic biomarkers of dementia
- Will rank ADRD detection ability between models incorporating linguistic biomarkers, acoustic biomarkers, and non-invasive network traffic patterns

The Role of Context in Predictive Preactivation Across the Lifespan Sep 2025 - Present

INDEPENDENT RESEARCH - NYU; CoMM Lab (Communicative Sciences and Disorders Dept.)

- Compiled a literature review detailing the role of conversational and contextual cues in language processing and memory in younger and older adults
- Developed an experimental paradigm for an ongoing research project, which will be carried out via eye-tracking, EEG/ERP, and cognitive-computational modeling
- Applied for and obtained NSF GRFP fellowship status

Bilingualism, Aging, and Lexical Access Sep 2025 - Present

NYU; CoMM Lab (Communicative Sciences and Disorders Dept.)

- Collected eye-tracking data from older and younger Spanish-English bilinguals observing lexical retrieval during encoding
- Developed a poster centering the interplay between age and modality in the allocation of cognitive resources and the management of lexical competition across the lifespan, to be presented at HSP 2026 and Psychonomics 2026

Bilingualism, Contrastive Prosody, and Memory Oct 2024 - Present

INDEPENDENT RESEARCH - UCSB; PrPL Lab (Linguistics Dept.)

- Expanded on literature regarding memory for contrastive-pitch accents through an eye-tracking study in Cantonese-English bilinguals
- Compiled a literature review on contrastive prosody acquisition and L1 transfer in L2 English-learners
- Co-developed an ongoing study which will pinpoint the acoustic qualities used to learn English in L1 tonal language speakers via a model-fitting approach

Contrastive Prosody, Cognitive Resource Allocation, and Memory Aug 2023 - Present

INDEPENDENT RESEARCH - UCSB; PrPL Lab (Linguistics Dept.)

- Collaborated with professionals (Dr. Laurel Brehm; Dr. Scott Fraundorf) to expand foundational pitch accenting literature
- Collected, cleaned, and analyzed eye-tracking data to establish causal links between contrastive prosody, fixation-mediated attention, and recognition memory
- Designed a set of 240 stimuli to be used within the visual world paradigm
- Authored a 34-page thesis and developed a manuscript which is currently in preparation for

publication

Production and Perception of Language Aug 2023 - Jun 2025
UCSB; PrPL Lab (Linguistics Dept.)

- Partnered with the MOXI science center (Santa Barbara, CA) to promote science communication and conduct real-world psycholinguistics research
- Recruited and worked with children and adults for three different experiments on the acquisition of novel words (30h)
- Coded and analyzed speech errors in sentence-completion output for >100 participants
- Instructed undergraduate RAs in the use of portable and stationary eye-tracking equipment
- Participated in a research initiative to enhance diversity in language science research using LLMs

Acquisition of Tonal Languages Apr 2023 - Jun 2024
UCSB; Mayer Lab (Psychological and Brain Sciences Dept.)

- Collaborated with native Mandarin speakers and opera singers to establish grading scales for musical pitch productions and second-language Mandarin utterances
- Spliced and categorized audio files from >60 participants using Shotcut (30h)
- Scored second-language Mandarin learners on pitch-accent replication and production of basic Pinyin and pitch contours (40h)
- Conducted statistical analyses on the correlation between musical pitch ability and success in pitch-contour production in Mandarin

Language of Trigger Warnings Jul 2023 - Dec 2023
UCSB; Literature and Mind Program (English Dept.)

- Assembled a 94-page review summarizing educational, political, and psychophysiological consequences of trigger warning use
- Prepared and delivered a well-attended campus presentation and Q+A session on trigger warnings and trauma
- Led a discussion panel for the Trauma-Informed Pedagogy Initiative on the language and rhetoric of trigger warnings in education

LEADERSHIP, SERVICE, & MENTORSHIP

NYU SHARE-CSD Jun 2026 - Jul 2026
NYU; Mentor, Supervisor

- Supervised undergraduate students interested in CSD in an intensive six-week research immersion program
- Mentored undergraduate students, presented workshops on the research process, and gave tailored advice on students' graduate school aims

Center for Health and Rehabilitation Research (CoHRR) Apr 2026
NYU; Organizing Committee

- Served as a member of the scientific committee for the CoHRR 2026 Showcase
- Coordinated roundtable panels for trainees and faculty members to discuss current issues and questions

Independent Science Research (ISR) Program Jan 2026 - Present
Spence School; Mentor

- Established one-on-one mentorship connection with a student from a local high school with an

interest in psycholinguistics and neurolinguistics research
- Will supervise my mentee in the development, carrying out, and analysis of their own language science research project (2-year commitment)

NYU Aging and Technology Nov 2025 - Present
NYU; Organizing Committee
- Will organize and volunteer at two coffee-hour roundtables that culminate in a grant-writing workshop
- Analyzed survey data from conference attendees, creating table groups tailored to their research specializations, skills offered, and resources needed
- Served as a volunteer during the conference, recording brainstorm notes for tables of professionals working in the aging and technology research sphere

Alpha Sigma Kappa (ASK): Women in Technical Studies Sep 2022 - Jun 2024
General Member
- Regularly volunteered with philanthropic organizations for beach cleanups, necessities drives, academic enrichment panels, etc. (>60h)
- Raised upwards of $1000 in fundraisers for programs including Coastal Fund, Donors Choose, and Girls Inc.

Vice President of Operations (May 2023 - May 2024)
- Managed Big-Little mentorship program for women and nonbinary students in STEM fields
- Coordinated events and reserved locations for a large (>50) student organization
- Communicated with the executive, chapter, and national boards to refine and revise ASK bylaws

Professional Fraternity Council (PFC) Representative (May 2023 - May 2024)
- Collaborated with other PFC representatives across on-campus professional organizations to host networking events for PFC members (>50h)

College of Letters (CLS) and Science Honors Program Jun 2021 - Jun 2024
UCSB; Academic Track
- Completed 40h of community service, specializing in tutoring and ESL instruction for underprivileged families in the Santa Barbara community
- Designed and completed an undergraduate honors thesis
- Enrolled in intensive, supplemental courses intended to expand and enrich student experiences (>6 seminars)

UCSB Community Affairs Board Sep 2020 - Jun 2021
UCSB; Tutor (Remote)
- Worked as a virtual tutor 1-2x/week for underprivileged families through UCSB CAB's "Family Literacy Program"
- Maintained a balance in sessions between homework help for students and supplemental reading and language instruction for parents seeking ESL experience

HONORS & AWARDS

Honors
- Dean's Honors List (UCSB CLS)
- Letters and Science Honors Program (UCSB CLS)

Awards

- 2026-2029 NSF GRFP Fellow (CSD Dept., NYU)
- 2024 Outstanding Senior Award (Linguistics Dept., UCSB)
- 2024 Hyung Il Pai Award for Korean Language (East Asian Language and Cultural Studies Dept., UCSB)

SKILLS & INTERESTS

Skills and Certifications: R, eye-tracking (EyeLink Duo, WebGazer), Python (limited), Qualtrics, Excel, MoCA, MMSE-2, Praat, Gorilla, ExperimentBuilder

Languages: Spanish (limited), Korean (limited)

Research Interests: Cognitive aging, neurodegenerative disease, neuroscience of language and cognition, predictive preactivation, neural basis of language and memory, attention/awareness and processing, real-world language science, science communication, statistical and computational modeling, machine learning